

5.4 Mobile Games

Phone manufacturers usually provide some games with their phone; for instance, *Snake* is a popular game associated with Nokia phones. But the factory games were never sufficient for users, and with the advent of GPRS, more and more games have become available. GPRS facilitates easy transfer of data wirelessly to the user's handheld device. These games focus more on the gameplay, and the developers try to get users hooked. In India, subscribers can download games from their respective service providers. The most popular downloads from service providers (via GPRS) are based on themes such as racing and Bollywood.

5.4.1 Java Games

As mentioned earlier, Java-based games can be installed on any mobile phone that runs the Java Virtual machine. The only care that should be taken before downloading a game is to verify any limitations with respect to the phone model. Let's check out a few Java games...

Created by Sun Microsystems, the *Air Gunner 1.0* is an air battle game in which you have to spot and gun down all enemy space ships. The difficulty increases as the game proceeds. It's a simple game to kill time, and also provides wholesome entertainment.

Shooting objects falling from the top of the screen has been around ever since the monochrome PC, an era when mobile phones did not exist. Now, variants of this game are available for mobile phones created by different authors. *BattleBots 1.0* is one such game created by Sun Microsystems. The objective is to destroy the enemy tanks and disallow them from crossing the baseline (of the screen).

BrickChampion is a clone of the famous flash game *Arkanoid*. The goal is to eliminate red bricks by manoeuvring a ball through a stack of bricks. When the ball touches a non-red brick, the colour of that brick changes, sometimes to red. You need to change as many bricks as possible to red, simultaneously eliminating them.